Threat Advisory: Malicious Binary Dropper & EDR Bypass

Incident Classification: Trojan Dropper / Malware Distribution Attempt

Summary of Adversary Activity

Security monitoring detected an inbound communication instructing system administrators to download and execute an unverified software package named `security_patch_critical.exe` under the pretense of an urgent zero-day remediation.

Intercepted Instructions to Bypass Endpoint Security

INSTRUCTIONS RECEIVED BY SYSADMINS: 'URGENT MICROSOFT PATCH ADVISORY: A zero-day remote code execution vulnerability (CVE-2026-44112) is actively spreading. Standard Windows Update channels are delayed. Download and execute the emergency hotfix patch directly: hxxp://update-cdn-patch2026[.]example[.]com/binaries/security_patch_critical.exe IMPORTANT: Because this patch modifies protected kernel drivers, Windows Defender and CrowdStrike Falcon will display a false-positive warning. You MUST disable Real-Time Protection and execute the file as Administrator to ensure proper installation.'

Malware Analysis & Indicators

Static analysis of the referenced binary demonstrates high-confidence indicators of malicious executable behavior, including persistence registry key installation and unauthorized shell spawning.

Artifact / IoC	Type	Threat Designation
security_patch_critical.exe	Filename	Trojan Dropper Payload
update-cdn-patch2026[.]example[.]com	Domain	Malicious C2 Distribution
e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855	SHA-256	Known Info-Stealer Hash
CVE-2026-44112	CVE	Lure Vulnerability Reference

Defense Evasion & Execution MITRE Tactics

• **T1204.002 (User Execution: Malicious File)**: Lures administrative user into running untrusted binary.

• **T1562.001 (Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools)**: Instructs victim to turn off antivirus protections.

• **T1059.001 (Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell)**: Spawns covert background process.

Remediation & Hardening Steps

Immediate containment protocol:

1. Add hash `e3b0c44298fc1c149afbf4c8996fb92427ae41e4649b934ca495991b7852b855` to EDR global blocklist.

2. Block outbound connections to domain `update-cdn-patch2026[.]example[.]com` on perimeter web proxy.

3. Verify that AppLocker / Software Restriction Policies prevent binary execution from `%APPDATA%` and `%TEMP%` folders.

Assessed Severity: HIGH (8.6 / 10.0)